

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠7

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥10

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦7

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦Q

Board: 6

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣K

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 9 4 2
♣ J 10 8 3

♠ K 5

♥ Q J 10 8 3

♦ K Q J

♣ 9 6 2



♠ 10 8 7 2

♥ A 6

♦ A 10 8

♣ Q 7 5 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ K 9 5 2

♦ 7 6 5 3

♣ A K

NORTH has a minimum 1♥ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of NORTH's ♥s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and bids 4♥.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♠7

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 2

♥ Q J

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ J 8 4

♠ 5

♥ 10 8 4

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ 10 7 6 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 10 8 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ A K 3

♣ 9

♠ 6 3

♥ 9 7 6 3 2

♦ 8 2

♣ A K Q 2

*West**North**East**South*

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

Pass

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣K

EAST has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

WEST has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

EAST now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8
♥ Q 10 9 2
♦ K 7 5 4
♣ 10 9 5

♠ J 10 9 4 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ 9

♣ K 8 6 3



♠ Q
♥ K J 8 4
♦ Q J 10 6 2
♣ Q 7 2

♠ A 7 6 5 2

♥ 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ A J 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South

Lead: ♥ 10

SOUTH has 14 points and opens 1 ♠, her 5-card Major.

NORTH could bid 3 ♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea, when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid the game. So North should bid 4 ♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7
 ♥ 10 9 8 6 3
 ♦ A 6 2
 ♣ A 8

♠ Q 5 2

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 10 7 4

♣ J 10 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 4

♥ A K 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ K 9 6 2

♠ K J 10 6 3

♥ Q J

♦ 9 8 5

♣ Q 7 3

West

1 ♥

North

Pass

East

4 ♥

South

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

Lead: ♦ 7

WEST has 13 points so he must open. He has five ♥s so he should open 1 ♥.

EAST, with 14 points and four ♥s knows there are enough points for a game contract and at least nine ♥s between the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so EAST bids 4 ♥.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 7 3
♥ 10 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ 10 9 5 3

♠ K 9

♥ A K J 6 5

♦ A 10 5

♣ A 7 6



♠ J 6 5 4

♥ 9 7

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ J 8 4

♠ Q 8 2

♥ Q 8 4 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ K Q 2

NORTH has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1♥.

SOUTH has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3♥.

NORTH is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows SOUTH has 12 points at most, so she should take the safe position and just bid 4♥.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Lead: ♦Q

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2

♥ K Q 3

♦ 8 6

♣ 9 5

♠ 10

♥ A 8 6 4

♦ K J 9 3

♣ Q 10 8 7



♠ A J 6 5 3

♥ J 10 9

♦ A Q 5 4

♣ 6

♠ K

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A K J 4 3 2

West

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♣K

North

Pass

East

1♠

South

Pass

WEST passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

EAST naturally opens 1♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

WEST might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4♠.